

7 Security

Till Mac OS 9, the focus was more on ease of use and interface, thus sidelining security features. However, it still remained secure to a large extent due to the relative obscurity of Mac OS as a platform, deeming it unattractive to attackers. Almost all of these fundamental vulnerabilities such as the existence of a full pre-emptive multitasking routine (a feature that blocks and protects the memory allotted to each program separately, so that the system is more stable and malware cannot affect the functionality of other processes) and multiple user support, have been corrected in Mac OS X.



Mac OS X has enhanced features in its security menu

While Mac OS X supports all default security features such as multiple user support and built-in firewalls, versions from Mac OS X 10.3 (Panther) onwards support advanced features such as parental control, file encryption and most recently, built-in malware detector.

7.1 Multi-user support

This feature is available on all versions of Mac OS X. When you first switched your Mac, you were asked to give your user information. If you wish to add multiple users, do the following: